

## HANZHONG SUN (He/Him/His)

PhD Candidate, Second Language Studies, Educational Studies Program  
School of Education, University of Cincinnati, Cincinnati, Ohio, United States

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<https://orcid.org/0000-0003-3739-1984>

### EDUCATION

|                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|---------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2027 Spring<br>(expected) | University of Cincinnati<br>PhD, Second Language Studies (cumulative GPA: <b>4.0/4.0</b> , 96 credit hours earned)<br>Dissertation: <i>When Second Language Learners Meet English Epicene Pronouns: Use, Perception, and Learning</i> (tentative title)<br>Committee: Drs. Hye K. Pae (Chair), Evthokia Saclarides, and Mark Sulzer |
| 2026 Fall<br>(expected)   | University of Cincinnati<br>MA, Educational Psychology and Child Studies (cumulative GPA: <b>4.0/4.0</b> )<br>Thesis: <i>TBD</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| 2017                      | South China Normal University, Guangzhou, China<br>MA, Linguistics and Applied Linguistics                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| 2014                      | Ningbo University, Ningbo, China<br>BA, in English Language and Literature                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |

### NON-DEGREE EDUCATION

|                           |                                                                                                                                                                 |
|---------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2026 Fall<br>(expected)   | University of Cincinnati<br>Graduate Certificate, Teaching English to Speakers of Other Languages (TESOL)                                                       |
| 2026 Summer<br>(expected) | University of Birmingham<br>Certificate, Corpus Linguistic Summer School 2026                                                                                   |
| 2026 Summer<br>(expected) | The Education University of Hong Kong<br>Certificate, Academic Summer Institute on Language Education<br>Ecological Languageing: Linguistics for the Real World |

### PROFESSIONAL POSITIONS

|             |                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2025 - 2026 | University of Cincinnati, Ohio, United States (10 hrs/wk)<br>Instructor of Record, the Center for English as a Second Language                                                                      |
| 2025 - 2026 | University of Cincinnati (10 hrs/wk)<br>Graduate Research Assistant, Learning by Design Lab<br><i>Assisted with data entry, coding, and analysis for a preschooler literacy development project</i> |
| 2025 Summer | University of Cincinnati (80 hrs)<br>Graduate Teaching Assistant, School of Education                                                                                                               |
| 2023 - 2025 | University of Cincinnati (20 hrs/wk)<br>Graduate Research Assistant, Evaluation Services Center                                                                                                     |

*Assisted a team of research associates in performing tasks in various projects spanning the areas of education, public health and human services*

- *Managed datasets, e.g., entering, analyzing & coding data*
- *Created tables and graphs using Excel and RStudio*
- *Searched and reviewed literature*
- *Designed conference slides and posters*
- *Reviewed and checked final project reports*
- *Performed other project-related tasks*

|             |                                                                                |
|-------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2020 - 2023 | Quzhou University, Quzhou, China<br>Lecturer, College English Department       |
| 2020 - 2022 | Quzhou University<br>Associate Director, College English Department            |
| 2017 - 2019 | Quzhou University<br>Assistant Lecturer, College English Department            |
| 2017 - 2019 | Quzhou University<br>Research Secretary, School of Foreign Languages           |
| 2015 - 2016 | South China Normal University<br>Teaching Assistant, School of Foreign Studies |

## AERAS OF SPECIALIZATION

- Broad areas: (instructed) second language acquisition, psycholinguistics, applied linguistics, English for academic purposes
- Specific topics: vocabulary use, learning, teaching, and processing; epicene pronouns (use, perception, learning, teaching, and processing); academic writing (emotion, genre analysis, and meta-discourse analysis); generative AI in second language education

## PUBLICATIONS

Note: SSCI = Social Sciences Citation Index; A&HCI = Arts & Humanities Citation Index; SCI = Sciences Citation Index; ESCI = Emerging Sources Citation Index; IF = impact factor

### Peer-Reviewed Journal Research Articles

- Pae, H.K., Xia, D., **Sun, H.**, Chen, Y., ...Sedaghat, A.R. (53 authors) (2026) Translation and cross-cultural adaptation of the Chronic Rhinosinusitis Control Test for global use. *International Forum of Allergy & Rhinology*. (SCI Q1, IF = 6.8)
- Xia, D., Chen, Y., **Sun, H.**, Pae, H.K. (2026). Both quantity and quality matter: Investigating the presence and effectiveness of key argumentative elements in students' persuasive writing. *International Journal of Applied Linguistics*. Advance online publication. <https://doi.org/10.1111/ijal.70174> (SSCI Q1, IF = 1.7; A&HCI; Scopus Q1)
- Sun, H.**, Fang, S., & Pae, H. K. (2026). Chinese EFL learners' use of English synonyms: A mixed methods study. *International Journal of TESOL Studies*. 8(3), 29–47. <https://doi.org/10.58304/ijts.250524> (Scopus Q1)
- Sun, H.**, Luo, X., & Pae, H.K. (2026). "A student is working on *their* own project": A systematic review of epicene singular *they* by learners of English. *SN Social Sciences*, 6, Article 60.

- <https://doi.org/10.1007/s43545-026-01312-z> (Scopus Q2)
- Sun, H.**, Cheng, W., Pae, H. K., & Wang, L. (2025). Gender bias in Chinese EFL writing: A corpus-based study of epicene pronouns. *Linguistics and Education*, 89, Article 101464.  
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.linged.2025.101464> (SSCI Q1, IF = 2.1; A&HCI; Scopus Q1)
- Sun, H.**, Luo, X., & Pae, H. K. (2025). Changing gendered language in English academic writing? Epicene pronoun usage in learners' research manuscripts and gender-inclusive practices in journal guidelines. *Changing English: Studies in Culture and Education*, 32(3), 325–339.  
<https://doi.org/10.1080/1358684X.2025.2477999> (ESCI; Scopus Q1)
- Sun, H.**, & Pae, H. K. (2025). Never judge a person by *his*, *his or her*, or *their* appearance: Spotlighting the use of gender-neutral pronouns among learners of English. *The Journal of Asia TEFL*, 22(1), 113–122. <https://doi.org/10.18823/asiatefl.2025.22.1.7.113> (Scopus Q2)
- Sun, H.**, & Fang, S. (2022). Paired-associate second language vocabulary learning: The role of L1 translation familiarity. *The Journal of Asia TEFL*, 19(1), 50–65. (Scopus Q2)  
<http://doi.org/10.18823/asiatefl.2022.19.1.4.50>
- Sun, H.**, & Fang, S. (2021). What constitutes vocabulary learning difficulty? A classroom-based study of semantic relatedness and L1 familiarity effects on L2 word learning. *Australian Journal of Applied Linguistics*, 4(3), 82–102. <https://doi.org/10.29140/ajal.v4n3.545>
- Sun, H.** (2020). Is L2 exposure always a strong modulator of L1 influence? Evidence from Chinese EFL learners acquiring English collocations. *International Journal of English Linguistics*, 10(5), 23–38.  
<https://doi.org/10.5539/ijel.v10n5p23>

#### Peer-Reviewed Book Chapters

- Pae, H. K., Xia, D., **Sun, H.**, & Allen, E. (2026). BE-yond orthographic simplicity: A corpus-based analysis of copula BE overuse in ESL writing by native Chinese speakers. In T. Liu, M. Chen, & Y. Tono (Eds.). *Corpus linguistics in Asian contexts*. Springer.
- Pae, H. K., Tian, L., Xia, D., & **Sun, H.** (2026). Educational equity and efficacy: Addressing academic standards in and through project-based learning and teaching. In G. H. Beckett & H. K. Pae (Eds.). *Project-based learning in language and content teacher education: Interdisciplinary and multimodal perspectives* (pp. 19–36). Routledge. <https://doi.org/10.4324/9781003636588-3>
- Pae, H. K., **Sun, H.**, & Babu, M. (2026). The role of syllables in Korean word recognition and reading: A meta-analysis. In H. Wiskel & H. K. Pae (Eds.). *Handbook of nonlinear writing system—Complex processes and learning challenges*. Springer.
- Pae, H. K., & **Sun, H.** (2025). Beyond script universality: A meta-analysis of transposition effects on visual word recognition in Hangul. In H. K. Pae, H. Wiskel, & S. Y. Kim (Eds.). *Handbook on the Korean language and literacy: Insights into Hangul and text processing* (pp. 211–235). Springer.  
[https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-031-88087-2\\_11](https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-031-88087-2_11)

#### Report

- Glueckert, K., Holton, J., **Sun, H.**, & Schutzman, C. (2024, September). *ARP ESSER Extended Learning and Recovery: Phase 2 Analysis Report*. Cincinnati, Ohio: Evaluation Services Center, University of Cincinnati.

## Book Reviews

Language Weaponization (looking for a journal)

Presentation of self in academic support genres: Job application statements (looking for a journal)

**Sun, H.**, Pae, H. K., & Tian, L. (2026). Adaptable English language teaching: Advances and frameworks for responding to new circumstances. *ELT Journal*. Advance online publication.

<https://doi.org/10.1093/elt/ccag018> (SSCI Q1; A&HCI)

**Sun, H.**, Fang, S., & Pae, H. K. (2026). Doing vocabulary research. *Applied Linguistics*. Advance online publication. <https://doi.org/10.1093/applin/amag028> (SSCI Q1)

**Sun, H.**, & Pae, H. K. (2025). Corpora, collocation, and language learning. *The Journal of Asia TEFL*, 22(1), 199–202. <https://doi.org/10.18823/asiatefl.2025.22.1.16.199> (ESCI; Scopus Q2)

**Sun, H.**, & Pae, H. K. (2024). Creativity in second language acquisition. *System*, 123, Article 103315. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.system.2024.103315> (SSCI Q1)

**Sun, H.**, & Pae, H. K. (2024). English L2 vocabulary learning and teaching: Concepts, principles, and pedagogy. *TESOL Journal*, 15(4), Article e804. <https://doi.org/10.1002/tesj.804> (ESCI; Scopus Q1)

**Sun, H.**, Fang, S., & Pae, H. K. (2023). Research methods in vocabulary studies. *The Social Science Journal*. Advance online publication. <https://doi.org/10.1080/03623319.2023.2278281> (SSCI Q2)

**Sun, H.**, & Pae, H. K. (2023). Vocabulary in the foreign language curriculum: Principles for effective instruction. *System*, 115, Article 103060. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.system.2023.103060> (SSCI Q1)

**Sun, H.**, Fang, S., & Pae, H. K. (2022). Cross-linguistic influence and second language learning. *System*, 110, Article 102927. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.system.2022.102927> (SSCI Q1)

## **RESEARCH GRANTS**

### Funded Research Grants

[1] CECH 2025-2026 Graduate Student and Faculty Mentoring Grant (1,000 USD, in progress, student PI; collaborating faculty PI: Dr. Hye K. Pae, top-ranked proposal)

[2] The University of Cincinnati's Graduate College and Office of Research 2025-2026 University Research Council (URC) Graduate Student Stipend and Research Cost Program for Faculty-Student Collaboration (8,500 USD, in progress, student PI; collaborating faculty PI: Dr. Hye K. Pae)

Note: The University of Cincinnati's oldest and most prestigious internal funding mechanism

[3] CECH 2024-2025 Graduate Student and Faculty Mentoring Grant (2,000 USD, in progress, student PI; collaborating faculty PI: Dr. Hye K. Pae, top-ranked proposal)

[4] CECH 2023-2024 Graduate Student and Faculty Mentoring Grant (1,000 USD, completed, student PI; collaborating faculty PI: Dr. Hye K. Pae)

[5] University-Level Teaching Reform Project of Quzhou University, 2019 (5,000 CNY, completed, faculty PI)

Title: *Study of Teacher Interactional Competence in College English Class: A Systemic Functional Linguistics Informed Approach*

[6] Zhejiang Provincial Education Science Research Project, 2018 (2,000 CNY, completed, faculty PI)

Title: *The Semantic Knowledge Acquisition of English Synonyms among Chinese EFL Students*

Grant Applications Submitted but Not Selected for Fundings

[1] 2026 Dean's Dissertation Completion Fellowship (one of the two nominations made by the School of Education)

**AWARDS** (selected)

- [1] Evelyn Wenzel Memorial Scholarship Fund (Graduate), CECH, University of Cincinnati, 2026-2027 academic year (\$1,000)
- [2] "Be the Change" Scholarship, CECH, University of Cincinnati, 2026-2027 academic year (\$1,000)
- [3] Graduate Student Conference Travel Award, University of Cincinnati, 2024 (\$2,200), 2025 (\$1,800)
- [4] Ohio TESOL Conference Full-Time Student Grant Award, 2024 (\$90)
- [5] National Scholarship for Graduate Students, Ministry of Education, China, 2016 (¥20,000)
- [6] Outstanding Graduate Student, South China Normal University, China, 2016 (¥2,000)
- [7] First Class Scholarship, Graduate School, South China Normal University, China, 2016 (¥10,000), 2015 (¥10,000)
- [8] Second Class Scholarship, Graduate School, South China Normal University, China, 2014 (¥8,000)

**CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS** (\*presenter if multiple authors)

- \*Xia, D., Chen, Y., **Sun, H.**, Pae, H.K. (2026). Both quantity and quality matter: Investigating the presence and effectiveness of key argumentative elements in students' persuasive writing. Symposium on Second Language Writing, Kyoto, Japan [Paper presentation] (10/23-10/25/2026)
- \*Pae, H. K., **Sun, H.**, Xia, D., & \*Beckett, G. H. The efficacy of generative AI on students' performance in K-12 and higher education: A meta-analysis. American Educational Research Association (AERA), Los Angeles, California, the United States [Poster presentation] (4/8-4/12/2026)
- \***Sun, H.**, Xia, D., & Pae, H. K. Stance and affect in doctoral dissertation examiner reports: A cross-disciplinary corpus-based study. The Spring Research Conference, Cincinnati, Ohio, the United States [Paper presentation] (3/28/2026)
- \*Van, A., \***Sun, H.**, & Pae, H.K. Does GenAI really write like us? A systematic review of linguistic comparisons between GenAI and human texts. The Spring Research Conference, Cincinnati, Ohio, the United States [Paper presentation] (3/28/2026)
- Charles-Carlin, M., Adkins, R., Marcoux, J., Nie, E., Sullivan, E., **Sun, H.**, Van, A., Wall, M.C., & Raider-Roth, M. Exploring teaching-learning relationships in higher education. The Spring Research Conference, Cincinnati, Ohio, the United States [Paper presentation] (3/28/2026)
- \***Sun, H.**, Cheng, W., Pae, H. K., & Wang, L. Generic *he* or singular *they*? Epicene pronoun usage by Chinese EFL learners and ChatGPT. American Association for Applied Linguistics (AAAL), Chicago, Illinois, the United States [Paper presentation] (3/21-3/24/2026)
- \*Pae, H. K., & **Sun, H.** Syllabic configuration and its robust impact on lexical processing in Korean: Evidence from a meta-analysis. Association for Reading and Writing in Asia (ARWA), Kaohsiung City, Taiwan, China [Paper presentation] (3/5-3/6/2026)
- \***Sun, H.**, Luo, X., & Pae, H. Examining second language Learners' use of epicene pronouns in research manuscripts and gender-inclusive practices in journal guidelines. Purdue Linguistics Symposium, West Lafayette, Indiana, the United States [Paper presentation] (accepted but unable to attend, 4/11-4/12, 2025)
- \***Sun, H.**, Pae, H. K., & Luo, X. The effect of semantic relatedness on second language vocabulary learning: A systematic review. The Spring Research Conference, Lexington, Kentucky, the United States [Paper presentation] (3/29/2025)

- \***Sun, H.**, Cheng, W., Pae, H. K., & Wang, L. Gender diversity expressed in Chinese EFL learners' writing: A corpus-based study of epicene pronouns. American Association for Applied Linguistics (AAAL), Denver, Colorado, the United States [Paper presentation] (3/22-3/25/2025)
- \***Sun, H.**, & Pae, H. K. Never judge a person by *his* appearance: Spotlighting English learners' use of gender-neutral pronouns. Ohio TESOL Conference, Columbus, Ohio, the United States [Paper presentation] (11/21-11/22/2024)
- \*Glueckert, K., Holton, J., Schutzman, C., & **Sun, H.** Learning recovery: Preliminary case study overview. Ohio Evaluation Services Center Program Cabinet, Ohio, the United States [Invited talk] (4/4/2024)
- Sun, H.** What predicts second language lexical recognition behavior? A proposal. The 6th Forum of Applied Linguistics at Guangdong University of Foreign Studies, Guangzhou, China [Paper presentation] (2021)
- Sun, H.** Syntactic or semantic? Pinning down the source of difficulty in acquiring English synonyms by Chinese EFL learners across two proficiency levels. Foreign Language Talents Training Conference, Quzhou, Zhejiang, China [Paper presentation] (2021)
- Sun, H.** Paired-associate second language vocabulary learning: The role of L1 translation familiarity. The 3rd National Conference on Instructed Second Language Acquisition, Wuhan, Hubei, China [Paper presentation] (2021) (selected as *Excellent Paper*)
- Sun, H.** Exploring the role of semantic relatedness and L1 familiarity in L2 word learning. The 4th National Forum on Educational Linguistics, Ningbo, Zhejiang, China [Paper presentation] (2019)
- Sun, H.** The influence of semantic relatedness and L1 translation familiarity on L2 word learning. The International Symposium on the Cognitive Neural Mechanism of Language, Qufu, Shandong, China [Paper presentation] (2018)
- \***Sun, H.** & Chen, Z. L1 transfer effect on the acquisition of L2 collocations. The 4th Forum of Applied Linguistics at Guangdong University of Foreign Studies, Guangzhou, Guangdong, China [Paper presentation] (2016)
- \***Sun, H.** & Chen, Z. A corpus-based comparative study of high-frequency verb HOLD. The 3rd Guangdong Postgraduate Academic Forum of Language and Literature, Guangzhou, Guangdong, China [Paper presentation] (2016) (second-prize winner)

## COURSES TAUGHT

### University of Cincinnati

- Teaching Assistant  
LSLS 7060 *Applied Linguistics* (2025 Summer; asynchronous online; graduate level; 31 students)
- Instructor of Record  
ESL 1069 Success in Academic Reading and Writing (2026 Spring; asynchronous online; undergraduate level; 10 students)

### Quzhou University

- Instructor of Record  
*English Intensive Reading* (2017 Fall to 2023 Spring)  
*IELTS Preparation* (2018 Fall)  
*English Practical Writing* (2020 Fall; 2021 Fall)  
*English Academic Writing* (2023 Spring)  
*Introduction to Linguistics* (2021 Fall; 2022 Spring)

### South China Normal University

- Instructor of Record  
*English Intensive Reading* (2015 Fall)

## COMMUNITY SERVICE

The WCPO 9 Scripps Regional Spelling Bee Competition Volunteer, Cincinnati Public Schools headquarters, Cincinnati, Ohio, United States, 3/7/2026  
Panel of Professional Development (*Research Academic Research Efficiently*), School of Education, University of Cincinnati, Cincinnati, Ohio, United States, 11/12/2025  
Professional Development Planning Committee, School of Education, University of Cincinnati, Cincinnati, Ohio, United States, 2025 Fall and 2026 Spring

- Attending monthly committee meetings to discuss professional development opportunities
- Planning two one-hour sessions for doctoral students at the School of Education

Student Panel, Graduate Student Orientation at the School of Education, University of Cincinnati, Cincinnati, Ohio, United States, 8/27/2025  
Move-in Volunteer for first-year undergraduates, Division of Student Affairs, University of Cincinnati, Cincinnati, Ohio, United States, 8/20/2025  
Reception Desk Volunteer, American Association for Applied Linguistics (AAAL) Conference, Denver, Colorado, United States, 3/21/2025  
Pre-conference Volunteer, Ohio TESOL Conference, Columbus, Ohio, United States, 11/20/2024

## PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

### Conference Proposal Reviewer

Second Language Research Forum (SLRF), 2025 (5 proposals) and 2026 (3 proposals)  
British Educational Research Association (BERA) Conference, 2025 (20 proposals)

### Journal Manuscript Reviewer

*Discover Artificial Intelligence* (Springer, 2026)  
*Discover Psychology* (Springer, 2025, 2026)  
*International Journal of Learner Corpus Research* (John Benjamins, 2025)  
*Forum for Education Studies* (Academic Publishing, 2025)  
*International Journal of Applied Linguistics* (Wiley, with Dr. Hye Pae, 2023)

### Book Chapter Reviewer

Springer (2024)

## CERTIFICATE

Ohio Literacy Library, Multilingual Learners Certificates: 10 Learning Modules (2025)  
Senior High School English Teacher Qualification Certificate (China, 2017)  
Higher Education English Teacher Qualification Certificate (China, 2018)

## PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIP

American Association for Applied Linguistics (AAAL, 2024-present)  
Asia Teaching English as a Foreign Language (TEFL, 2024-present)  
Ohio Teaching English to Speakers of Other Languages (Ohio TESOL, 2024-present)  
The International TESOL Union (ITU, 2025-present)  
Association for Reading and Writing in Asia (ARWA, 2025-present)  
Association for Diversity in Linguistics (2025-present)

## LANGUAGES

Mandarin Chinese (native)  
Wu Dialect, Shanghai-ese (native)  
English (fluent)

French (beginner)

Updated: 5/18/2026